Flounder

03 20

26 ISSUE

Issue: 3
Year: 2026
Newspaper: Satirical
Lyons: Conquered

FLOUNDER

FISH MARKET 50% OFF! ABOUT TO EXPIRE SALE!

Toronto's Weather Has Grown a Mind of Its Own 2

Good News: We Solved Climate Change 3

Punxsutawney Phil Exposed! 5

Mackenzie Intentionally Misaligns Clock Times to Create Time Zones within School 7

Living in a Paper "Perfect" Paradise 9

What Kind of End-of-Year Student Are You? 11

University Standards Have Crashed! 13

100% REVIEWED

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1

Toronto's Weather Has Grown a Mind of Its Own

Residents say the weather is following a “Nursery Rhyme”?

By: Joe

Toronto residents are raising concerns as the weather in the city begins behaving in a way that feels strangely familiar, especially to those who know the rhyme. Conditions have been switching from rain to sunshine and even snow within minutes, leaving people confused and completely unprepared for the day.

Many residents have begun to notice a pattern in this unusual behaviour. We spoke to Lindsey Garber, a teacher who grew up in Toronto, who said she has “never seen anything like this in all her years here,” adding that “it feels like we are following a nursery rhyme: It’s raining, it’s pouring, the old man is snoring... It’s sunny, it’s shining, the old man is whining.”

Another long-time resident said he no longer checks the forecast and instead “just waits to see which line of the rhyme we’re on.” Children around the city have begun giving warnings on clothing for the weather, as they know the rhyme the best. Even local wildlife is unprepared with birds beginning migration in the morning, and coming back out just 3 hours later. City weather reporters are now warning residents to carry multiple outfits at all times as weather conditions continue to shift rapidly without warning.

As theories about this “Mystery Weather Man” spread online, residents have begun to take matters into their own hands. It is reported that people have been banging pots outside their houses to prevent the old man from snoring, while others have yelled sad stories in hopes of extending periods of rain. Toronto police have asked everyone to “stop interfering with the old man” until more information is available. At the time of reporting it is currently raining, though sunshine is expected within minutes. The status of the old man remains unknown.

Good News: We Solved Climate Change

By E. Cogeak

Beloved reader,

We here at the Flounder care deeply for the environment. We find it terribly sad that Mother Nature is feeling down in the dumps– literally, since she's being buried under mountains of trash way bigger than you may think. For scale, those mountains are somehow larger than the pile of laundry on that one chair in your room (you know the one we're talking about). They're larger even than the awkward silence after one of your jokes doesn't land right.

cough...

Now, that being said, that doesn't mean that she is without help. This impending crisis has made people all over the world come together with their bold, slightly jumbled, inspiring, and incredibly misguided ideas and do their part in "helping" the Earth. In fact, here are some examples of things people have done, just this week, to put their own conscience at ease:

1. Posted an AI-generated photo of a sad polar bear with the caption "It's their planet too". Recent records show an exponential spike in polar bear happiness, and experts say it's all because of this post. Congratulations, @rsmith91, you've changed the world!
2. Used a sixth straw for one drink at the movies after the first five dissolved, then refrained from complaining about the papery taste of their drink and congratulated themselves on it for the rest of the day. 'Cause really, what better way to help the environment than to create more "recyclable" waste?
3. Bought their 11th reusable water bottle in six weeks, single-handedly keeping Owala in business and ensuring they never have to reuse the other ten.
4. Recycled their plastic Caesar salad container without washing it out ("The dressing will decompose, right? So it's basically recyclable"). They may have inadvertently poisoned a stray dog rooting through the trash, but at least they can give themselves a big pat on the back for doing their part.
5. Bought 25 reusable bags at the grocery store to reduce their future waste. Spoiler alert: they'll forget to bring every single one of them with them next time.
6. Switched to all possible eco-friendly products, throwing out everything they already have. After all, nothing says "eco-friendly" like tossing everything you own in the garbage.
7. Asked ChatGPT: "What are some ways I can help the planet? Also, can you write this essay for me?" After a few seconds of deep thought, they decided thinking is too hard and maybe AI should just do it for them.
8. Drove across the city in rush-hour traffic to attend a Save the Planet rally. They then found that it was too hot outside and chose to drive along the rally route with the air conditioning blasting. Greenhouse gases? Never heard of 'em.
9. Brought a hose to a river near their house to "fill it back up". Sure, 'cause that's how it works.

10. Left their fan on overnight for the whole week to generate “renewable wind energy”. This one was, to put it frankly, really disappointing. For us, and for them, when they get their electricity bill at the end of the month.
11. Turned off the lights for Earth Day while ordering online groceries, dog food, that one new shirt they’ve had their eye on for two weeks, and $100 worth of Temu technology. Those “ethically” sourced microchips are definitely environmentally sound... right?
12. Set their belongings on fire to protest consumerism. While they may have gotten arrested for arson, they sent a powerful message: “We the people are perfectly capable of creating air pollution all on our own.”

So you see, dear reader, the world is not entirely hopeless. With this level of dedication from heroes like the ones on this list, the world as we know it won’t end till next Tuesday. Wednesday if we’re lucky.

Punxsutawney Phil
EXPOSED!

Punxsutawney Phil (left), basking in his unearned glory.

It seems that spring has, finally, sprung. The sun is shining, the birds are singing, flowers are poking out of the melting snow. Spring brings with it renewal, new life, and change. It makes one feel hopeful after a long, depressing winter. Given how important this season is to our wellbeing, wouldn't it be great if it could arrive sooner? *Well, sure*, I hear you say, *but that's impossible. No one can control the climate.* You're right. No person can turn the seasons. However, there is a groundhog who can, and he's messing with us so he can coast by with the easiest job in the world. Beloved by all, but serving none, Punxsutawney Phil is scamming us all by working one day a year just to tell us something we already knew.

Groundhog Day is a tradition started in 1887 in the town of Punxsutawney of getting a groundhog (Phil) to look at his shadow to predict the end of winter. If he sees it (which he usually does), it means there will be six more weeks before spring is upon us. The way the ceremony is set up makes it seem as though Punxsutawney Phil is an immortal groundhog with weather-predicting powers. This simply isn't true. He is, in fact, an immortal groundhog with weather-*controlling* powers.

No one else seems to see it, but I know the truth. Phil is a groundhog who is able to control whether or not spring will come early and, 84% of the time, he makes sure it doesn't. He does this even though he knows that people will be happier if spring comes sooner. Why does he do this? Well, he knows if he lets spring come sooner more often, people would be less concerned with what he had to say. By keeping us freezing longer, pining for warmth, he makes sure we hang on his every word (or, glance). By doing so, he ironically makes his predictions less useful. I know that winter will last 6 more weeks most of the time. I don't need Phil to tell me that.

So, what happens when we worship Phil? He, his wife, and his two kids get cozy accommodations in a manmade burrow, with all the food, attention, and backscratches they could ask for. He is seen as a royalty in Punxsutawney, a benevolent king, held above all other animals. I think the truth of Phil is closer to that of a scheming dictator. Do not be swayed, dear reader, by Punxsutawney's seemingly innocent tradition. For, beneath it, a great evil lies, snacking on all the bananas his malevolent heart desires.

WORD SEARCH

E	Y	D	I	S	I	N	T	E	G	R	A	T	E
G	O	H	D	N	U	O	R	G	N	S	D	T	X
P	O	U	R	I	N	G	Y	W	E	P	T	U	P
Z	P	E	N	N	Y	S	I	X	T	E	I	C	L
Q	S	S	B	N	U	W	G	U	K	O	H	R	O
U	S	C	N	L	C	I	E	I	C	A	F	E	S
A	C	T	I	O	O	O	S	A	A	N	C	P	I
L	H	N	E	P	W	C	N	O	T	O	O	A	V
I	E	E	N	N	M	I	K	D	D	H	G	P	E
F	M	C	A	I	S	Y	N	A	I	A	E	W	A
I	I	A	O	U	E	G	L	G	G	T	K	R	N
E	N	D	T	G	A	S	L	O	N	E	I	P	X
D	G	S	N	E	Z	I	R	P	L	E	B	O	N
I	P	U	N	X	S	U	T	A	W	N	E	Y	N

SODA
PUNXSUTAWNEY
WEATHER
DISINTEGRATE
OLYMPICS
BLOCKAGE
QUALIFIED
PENNY
PAPERCUT
POURING
EXPLOSIVE
NOBEL PRIZE
GROUNDHOG
CONDITION
SCHEMING
SNOWING

Mackenzie Intentionally Misaligns Clock Times to Create Time Zones within School

By Punk Chual

MACKENZIE - Many students have been complaining about the incorrect clocks around the school, which don't seem to exactly align with Eastern time. Some classrooms have read 4 minutes earlier, 2 minutes later, or even 40 minutes off in severe cases. While this may seem like simple human error in setting clock times, Flounder reporters have discovered that this is actually an intentional policy designed to create time zones within the school.

Around the world, time zones are set at around 15 degrees of longitude apart, at 1 hour differences between adjacent time zones. Thus, if one were located at the border of a certain time zone, they could be transported 1 hour into the past or future! This seems quite ridiculous, right?

The school seems to have come up with a solution for this folly. Creating time zones in Mackenzie is designed to create a more proportional and accurate time depending on location within the school.

As you learnt in grade 9 geography class, in Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) every degree of longitude (roughly 80 km in Toronto) equates to around 4 minutes of difference. However, given that the school isn't that large, they may have miscalculated these different times.

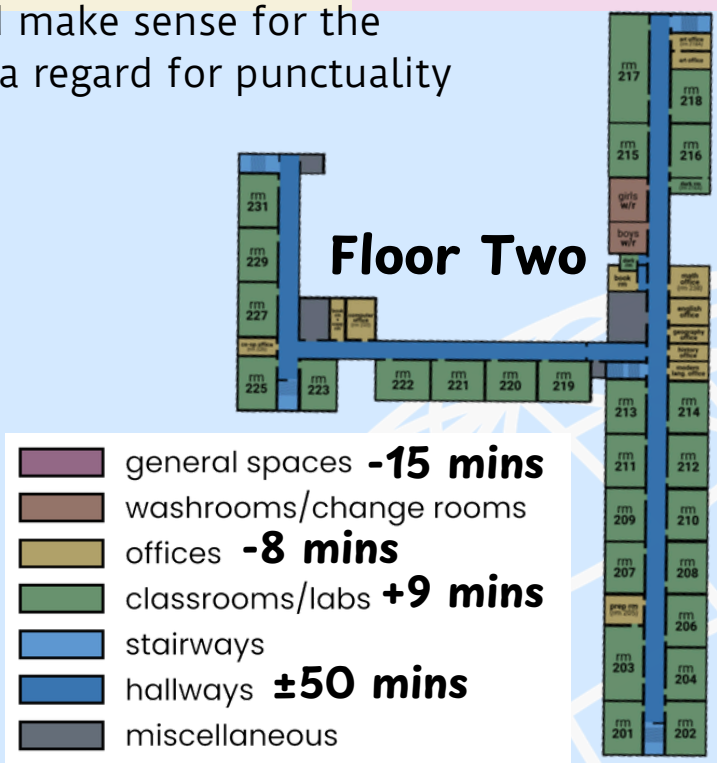
VII

After this time zone plan surfaced, many students reached out with complaints. Grade 12 student Layt Foklas stated: “The fact that they didn't share the reason behind this shows that they know it's nonsense too! Even if I leave 5 minutes early for my first class, I'll be late for my second...”

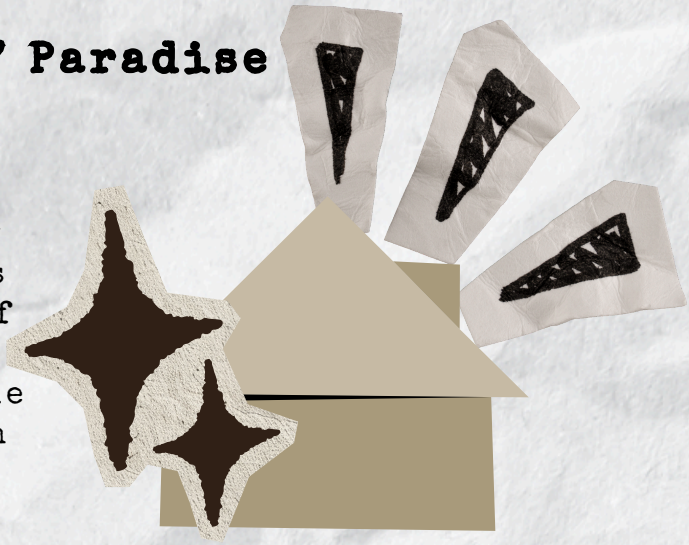
However we did find one student in support of the school's misaligned clocks. An anonymous student has stated, “My classes are aligned in just a way where I have 10 minute breaks between classes! I say let the system stay.”

The big question still stands; who was responsible for this? While we don't have solid evidence, many of our Flounder journalists have suspected that the Lyon newspaper may have had a part. There have been several reports of Lyon issues having severely postponed release dates and little action in the school year. Given the carelessness with how the clock changes have impacted students’ punctuality, it would make sense for the perpetrators to not have such a regard for punctuality themselves.

It is currently unclear whether this system will continue. While there was a meeting to discuss future action, the majority of people didn't show up at the scheduled time. Thus, it's safe to say that any decisions regarding the school times will be severely delayed.

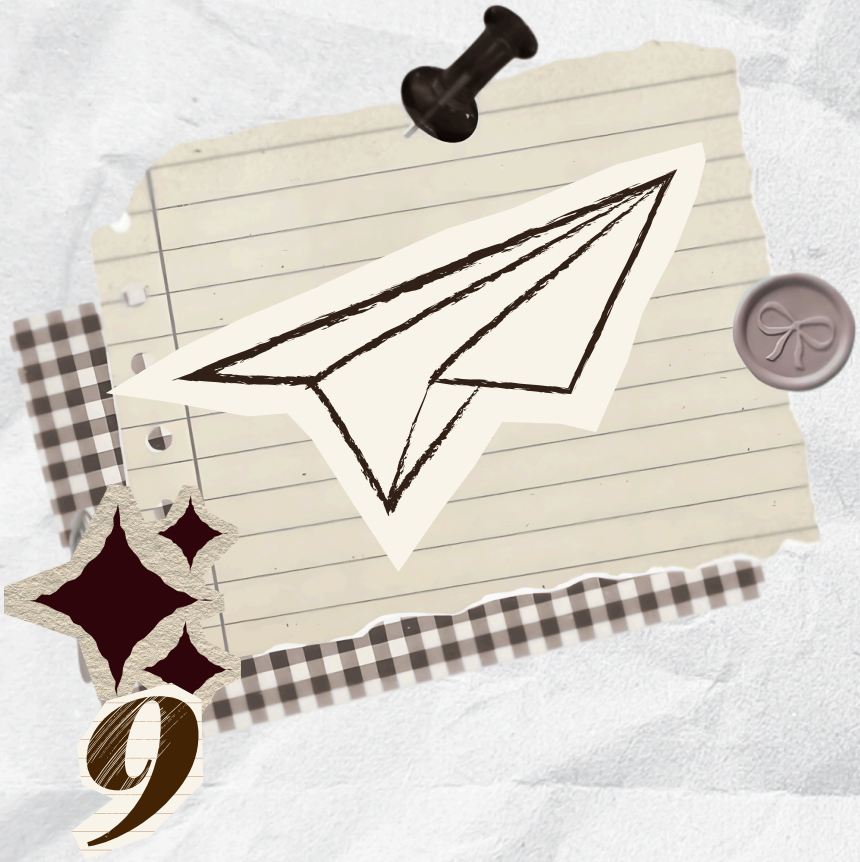


Living in a Paper "Perfect" Paradise
By: Penny Papercut



In honour of Earth Day, the entire world has officially replaced every single object with paper. Yes, that's right—paper: The thin sheet made of processed wood that everyone has collectively decided is now suitable for absolutely everything. Although this project has taken a while (only like 20 years), this decision is certainly a groundbreaking step towards sustainability.

On Wednesday morning, citizens woke up to a paper wonderland. Their beds were made out of paper. Their cars were made out of paper. Their house...you name it, paper! The paper neighbourhood itself is a bit irregular, like failed origami, but some argue that it only adds character. Nearby, newly built paper apartments have impressed buyers with their modern, minimalistic design and natural ventilation, especially after the walls dissolved slightly during the drizzle. All it took was just one sneeze to wipe down an entire neighbourhood.



From then on, citizens have brushed their teeth with paper toothbrushes and drank water from paper water bottles. Bottles dissolve before the cap is even fully twisted off, and it becomes a fun little race against dehydration. The new, fully recycled paper cars are super lightweight and fold neatly in the paper parking spaces, but there have been reports about these cars collapsing or flying away during rush hour. Wow, flying cars really do exist in 2026!

Luxury brands like Balenciaga are now selling paper jackets and paper footwear for only $9999.99 and your kidneys; what a steal! Despite their claim that their limited-edition paper raincoats are waterproof, their lifespan is approximately 10 seconds in Canada's extreme weather. Maybe 15 seconds if we're stretching it... Not only that, paper umbrellas have also become exceptionally popular! Offering users a quick but unforgettable, soaked experience in the rain, they are so effective that they disintegrate within minutes of rain contact—perfect for hydration!

This project might just be the greatest Earth Day achievement of the millennium. With plastic, glass, and metal removed from daily lives, the planet has experienced a major decrease in pollution. Every destroyed object can simply just be reused, reduced, and recycled. While there has been a 1000% increase in papercuts, citizens have already adapted to this paperific lifestyle, with paper umbrellas, paper clothing, and paper furniture becoming everyday essentials.. (At least until the weather forecast says otherwise...)

10

What Kind of End-of-Year Student Are You?

Choose the option that best matches your natural instincts in June.

1) Your motivation level right now is:

a. I have a detailed study schedule and I'm sticking to it
b. I will start tomorrow (definitely)
c. I will start after I take a short nap... or several
d. Motivation? Never heard of that

2) When a teacher says "this will be on the exam," you:

a. Take careful notes and highlight immediately
b. Pretend to write it down but forget instantly
c. Experience brief panic followed by acceptance
d. Mentally file it under "future me problem"

3) Your reaction to seeing grades posted:

a. Calm curiosity
b. Mild concern
c. Immediate emotional damage
d. I do not look. Ever.

4) Your approach to assignments in late June:

a. Submit early and stress-free
b. Submit on time but slightly messy
c. Submit 2 minutes before deadline with 14 typos
d. We had an assignment?

5) Your locker/backpack situation is best described as:

a. Neatly organized and labeled
b. Mostly organized, minor chaos
c. Controlled disaster
d. Archaeological dig site

6) Your summer plan is:

a. Productive schedule, goals, improvement
b. A loose plan that may or may not happen
c. "We'll see"
d. Sleep until September

Results:

Mostly A
The Overachieving Time Traveler

You are mentally already in September and possibly another timeline.

Mostly B
The Cautiously Functional Student

You are doing fine. Probably. You hope.

Mostly C
The Last-Minute Survivor

You operate on stress, deadlines, and pure instinct.

Mostly D
The Fully Disconnected

Your body may still be in school, but the rest of you left weeks ago.

University Standards Have Crashed!

"They accept anyone these days"

When university standards skyrocketed near the beginning of the school year, all the grade 12 students were trying their hardest to get into a school of their choice. It was expected that applicants started their own charities to solve global hunger and knew how to speak in 12 languages. But as time passed, seniors began to grow tired and just wanted to get into any school that they could. Eventually this extreme competitiveness took a toll on the grade 12s, and in spectacular human fashion, they did the most human thing they could do. They gave up.

Since then, university populations have sunk 20% and universities couldn't find anyone who qualified for their standards. The average grade 12 student's GPA plummeted from a 98% to a 54%. It seemed that the people in charge of these universities realized what was at stake. One Farvard trustee, Mr Dale says "I don't understand why no one is able to satisfy our criteria of landing on the moon. This is ridiculous."

As years passed, standards slowly began to decrease. One university no longer requires a gold medal in the Olympics to apply, only needing "Top 10 Finalist". Another removed having a Nobel Prize by age 5, changing it to age 10. Although professors were reluctant to make this change, it has continued to catch on and become normalized. However, even after all these changes, many students still had lost hope. One student, Fran Murr, went back to her family farm to teach her cows how to jump. Another student, Conan Vience, started working at a gas station.

It took a long time, but eventually universities realized it would be impossible to sustain their schools without people - and that it really didn't matter if you could swim a mile in 3 minutes in order to learn accounting. Standards have at last hit the floor. After slowly lowering criteria one by one, removing medal after medal, skill after skill, all that was really left was being able to breathe.

Soon, everyone got into university: super seniors well past their time, people who steal candy for fun, and a whole circus! Parents even enrolled their babies in hopes of getting them an early start. The halls slowly started filling up more and more. People who couldn't even do 3x3 were in Farvard. And it was all because they asked for too much. Professor Quint Err from Kale commented, "In my past 10 years of teaching, I have never had to teach someone old enough to be my dad and my own grandson in the same class."

Students who wanted a real education were rioting, because they were forced to sit next to toddlers and their moms while trying to learn. They were ready to leave, and so was everyone else. After all that desperation to prevent students from leaving, students proceeded to that exact thing. Once again, the halls of Kale were empty, Farvard was a graveyard for education, and Chrinceton lost a water fountain. Suffice to say, the human spirit is very good at quitting, and university standards will never be attainable.

The Flounder's 2025-2026 Year in Review

Age: 7 years old
Number of issues published: 3
Number of fishies employed: 30

Deadlines missed: 0*
**According to our records*

Fish-related puns made: Too many

Average article completion time: Either 3 weeks or 3 hours before publication

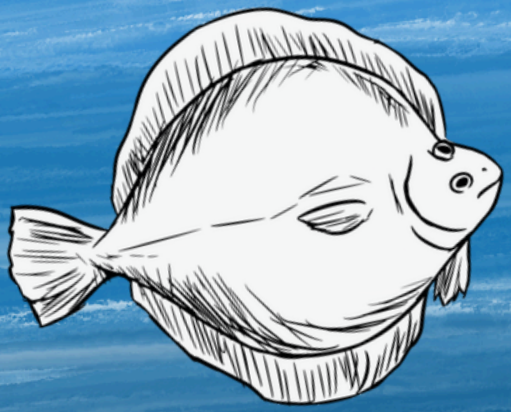
Favourite Food: Garlic bread

Percentage of Flounder staff surviving June: Under investigation

Articles not published in final issue: Classified

Thank you for reading this year!

We wish everyone the best of luck on exams and an unforgettable summer.



Yours Truly,
The Flounder

FLOUNDER #3/26

ILLUSTRATORS
AUTHORS
EDITORS

3

WEB
LAYOUT

Soda Prices Rise Amidst Attacks on Soda Factories

EAST MIDDLETON – Last week, Amber Smith and her friend Izzy Goldberg threw rocks at the FizzDream soda factory. Unfortunately, one of the rocks flew astray and hit the CEO of FizzDream in the head, causing him to permanently retire.

Yesterday, a new CEO was appointed by the remaining members of the board of directors of FizzDream.

In retaliation to Smith and Goldberg's attacks, the board of directors of FizzDream and other senior executives started throwing rocks at neighbouring soda factories in order to prevent them from producing soda.

In East Middleton, all of the soda factories lie along a single road, Straight Road. This road has only one exit, which is onto Ocean Street. All of the soda produced by the Straight Road factories is forced to go through the intersection with Ocean Street. These factories produce a significant portion of Canada's soda and are a critical component of the country's soda industry.

The board of directors of FizzDream blocked the exit from Straight Road onto Ocean Street by threatening to throw rocks at anyone who tries to go through the intersection. This has prevented all trucks carrying soda from delivering it to stores across the nation.

The road blockage resulted in a supply shortage of soda in Canada. This caused the soda prices to skyrocket, rising by 30% in just two weeks! Prices this high were not seen since pandemic lockdowns shut down the factories. Soda drinkers are emptying their wallets just to get the vital beverage they need.

"I can't believe the prices have gone up so much!" a carbonated drinks enthusiast complained. "I loooove soda, but now I am reconsidering my options. And just think of the people who drink soda because they have no other options at all! This situation Amber Smith caused is awful!"

The RCMP posted a strongly worded statement in relation to the crisis on Straight Road: "The RCMP strongly condemns the actions of Smith and Goldberg. Canada needs peace and soda, not rock throwing conflicts."

This is consistent with their comments on other conflicts and crimes in recent years. Canadians doubt that the RCMP would step in even if the conflict on Straight Road escalated into full blown riots across the country.

When asked what the purpose of her rock throwing was, Smith stated, "Izzy and I are worried that FizzDream is overpressurizing their cans, which would make them very explosive." It should be noted that Smith also possesses overpressurized soda cans. Last week's attack on FizzDream's factory was not the first time Smith had done something to a soda factory this year. In January, she kidnapped the CEO of PopCorp, a factory located in South Merrickville. She claimed that "he was pouring toxic chemicals into PopCorp's drinks". Currently, evidence suggests that PopCorp's CEO still lives in Smith's basement.

Many historians doubt the truthfulness of Smith's statements.
"There seems to be a recurring pattern in Amber Smith's activities," a history professor told the Flounder. "Both factories she attacked this year produce soda. I think what she's really after is not overpressurized cans or toxic chemicals, but rather the soda itself. This is also consistent with what Smith did in 2003 when she..."
Our interviewer promptly fell asleep, bored by the professor's lecture.
Smith is Canada's biggest soda addict, consuming around 20% of all soda produced. Many doctors have recommended that she decrease her soda consumption, but according to Smith, "The key to being the best person possible is to have carbonated beverage dominance."

The Flounder talked to an economist about Smith's plans. "If she controlled all the soda factories in Canada," the economist explained, "Smith could raise the prices as high as she liked, and she could make loads of money."

It has also been suggested that Smith and Goldberg started the conflict with FizzDream in order to distract the public from previous crimes the two women committed. They involved taking children to a "summer camp" on a private island. FizzDream's factory workers are greatly annoyed by the present situation. For the past few months, they have been on strike to protest the very strict board of directors. Now, the workers face both Smith and Goldberg's rock throwing and the brutal strike crackdown from management.

"What Smith did is just adding more fuel to the dumpster fire," the FizzDream factory workers' union leader lamented. "It's tough out here, advocating for the rights of FizzDream workers and protecting them from Smith and Goldberg's rocks. I only want the best for us and our factory, and I fight every day for it." She then ran off to break up a fight that started between a senior executive and a striking bottle capper.

A former FizzDream worker who now lives in Toronto expressed his concerns. "I have family members who live in East Middleton and work at the soda factories. The situation is just horrible and they are worried for their lives. All Smith had to do was not touch FizzDream while the workers were on strike, that's all she had to do." The fate of the conflicts between Smith, Goldberg, FizzDream, and the other Straight Road soda factories remains uncertain. For now, the price of soda remains high and will continue to rise. Soda drinkers should consider lowering their consumption or switching to alternatives such as sparkling water or fruit juice to save money.